First Aid Kit Preparedness

Pharmaceuticals – First Aid Kit Preparedness

Veterinarians are legally required to have a “valid veterinarian/patient relationship” in order to dispense prescription medications. This means your vet must have examined each of your horses in order to dispense medications to you. As many medications have potential side effects, a general wellness exam is necessary to ensure use of the medications is not contraindicated, and that you, as the administrator of the medication, are familiar with the drugs, their side effects and contraindications, and their appropriate usage.

Once you have established this relationship with your veterinarian, you should assemble a first aid kit. A first aid kit must be portable, relevant, and contain materials and drugs that are not expired. Below are items that should be included in your first aid kit:

Pharmaceuticals for First Aid Kit:

- Banamine paste – for pain, inflammation, and fever reduction
- Phenylbutazone (Bute) paste – for pain and inflammation
- Sedation – (discuss individually with your vet based on your horse’s health status)
- Tranquilizer – Acepromazine*
  - ***Do NOT use if hemorrhaging, as it is a vasodilator!***
  - ***Do NOT use on a fractious horse, as they can and will still kick!***
- Electrolytes
- Triple ophthalmic ointment
- Water-soluble topical ointment (SSD, Furacin, etc.)
- Corona or Scratches ointment

Equine First Aid Essentials

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Non-Pharmaceutical First Aid Kit Supplies:

Bandage Materials:

- Vet Wrap or Nylon Track Wraps × 4
- Quilted Sheets (No Bows) × 4
- Elasticon × 2
- Telfa Pads × 4 (Maxi pads also work)
- Duct Tape

Additional Supplies:

- Betadine solution (not scrub)
- Gauze
- Towel
- Gloves
- Tourniquet – 3 feet of stretchy rubber tubing
- Saline (make your own – does not need to be sterile but should be isotonic so it doesn't damage healthy cells: 1 teaspoon salt to 600 ml boiled water)
- Bucket
- Scissors
- Thermometer
- Flashlight
- Wire cutters
- Tweezers
- Hoof pick
- 60cc syringe with 16g needle
- Phone numbers